

Study Questions: Planning (Fiber & Flow)

1. How is color palette design an example of expected free energy minimization? What futures is the crocheter simulating?
2. Explain dye lot management as planning under uncertainty. What are the key sources of uncertainty, and how does the crocheter manage them?
3. Describe the process of matching a yarn to a project as multi-dimensional planning. What properties must be evaluated simultaneously?
4. How does yardage estimation combine material knowledge with mathematical prediction? What factors make estimation more or less accurate?
5. Why is crochet planning iterative rather than one-shot? Describe the plan-swatch-revise-execute cycle as an Active Inference loop.
6. How does the choice between pragmatic value (achieving the goal) and epistemic value (learning something new) shape project selection?
7. Describe how a crocheter plans for the visual impact of color pooling in a variegated yarn. What variables must they consider?
8. Why is buying yarn for a large project a planning challenge? What risks must the crocheter manage?
9. How does planning a gift project differ from planning a project for yourself? What additional predictions must be generated?
10. Describe the planning process for a multi-color project. How do decisions about color sequence, transition, and proportion interact?
11. Why do experienced crocheters plan their stash purchases? How is stash building a form of long-term project planning?

12. How does blocking plan into the design process? Why must the crocheter predict the effect of blocking when choosing yarn and planning dimensions?
13. Describe the planning challenges of a yarn substitution. What must the crocheter predict to ensure the substitute will work?
14. How does the concept of a tension swatch as a planning tool relate to Active Inference? What predictions does the swatch test?
15. Why is it important to plan for yarn joins in a long project? How does the crocheter predict where joins will fall and how to manage them?
16. How does seasonal planning (starting a winter project in summer) require the crocheter to predict future preferences and needs?
17. Describe the planning that goes into a collaborative project (e.g., a group blanket). How do multiple agents coordinate their plans?
18. How does budget planning for materials interact with creative planning? When do financial constraints shape design decisions?
19. What role does pattern selection play in the overall planning process? How does the crocheter evaluate whether a pattern matches their skill and material resources?
20. If you were planning a large-scale project (like a blanket with 12 colors), walk through the complete planning process from inspiration to first stitch. What predictions are generated at each stage?